

← Case report for event ID: 1012

ID	Alert rule	Description	Incident type	Severity level	Date and time detected
1012	Suspicious Parent Child Relationship	A suspicious process with an uncommon parent-child relationship was detected in your environment.	Process	Low	Dec 27th 2025 at 23:44

Alert details ▾

Incident report

Edit report

Incident classification

☒ True positive

☐ False positive

Case report

Please write a detailed report on the steps taken to analyse and contain this incident, including all relevant information and the rationale for its closure.

-Time of Incident: 12/27/2025 15:42:25.164

-User Involved: According to Company Info > Directory:
Name: Michelle Smith
Email: michelle.smith@tryhatme.com
Role: Legal

-Device: win-3459 (Windows host)

-Incident Details: At 12/27/2025 15:42:25.164, a process creation event was logged where svchost.exe (PID 3842) was launched with parent process services.exe (PID 3700). The process executed with command line C:\Windows\system32\svchost.exe -k wsappx -p from C:\Windows\system32\.. The activity was flagged due to an uncommon parent-child process relationship.

-Malware Identified: None identified.

-Additional info:
Parent Process: SERVICES.exe is the Windows Service Control Manager responsible for starting, stopping, and managing system services during system operation.

Does this alert require escalation?

☒ Yes

☐ No

Save and close alert

- Alert 1012: Process
- Identified as True Positive
 - Requires escalation to L2
 - Full Report Documented on the last page

splunk>enterpriseApps

MessagesSettingsActivityHelpFind

SearchAnalyticsDatasetsReportsAlertsDashboards

Search & Reporting

New Search

Save AsCreate Table ViewClose

1 host.name="win-3459" process.name="svchost.exe"

6 day window

1 of 3 events matchedNo Event Sampling

JobPauseStopRefreshDownloadVerbose Mode

Events (1)PatternsStatisticsVisualization

Format TimelineZoom OutZoom to SelectionDeselect

1 hour per column

Hide FieldsAll Fields

SELECTED FIELDS

a host 1

a source 1

a sourcetype 1

INTERESTING FIELDS

a datasource 1

a event.action 1

event.code 1

a hostname 1

a index 1

linecount 1

a process.command_line 1

a process.name 1

a process.parent.name 1

process.parent.pid 1

process.pid 1

a process.working_directory 1

a punct 1

a splunk_server 1

a timestamp 1

+ Extract New Fields

ListFormat50 Per Page

i	Time	Event
>	12/27/25 3:43:38.248 PM	<pre>{ [-] datasource: sysmon event.action: Process Create (rule: ProcessCreate) event.code: 1 host.name: win-3459 process.command_line: C:\Windows\system32\svchost.exe -k wsappx -p process.name: svchost.exe process.parent.name: services.exe process.parent.pid: 3700 process.pid: 3842 process.working_directory: C:\Windows\system32\ timestamp: 12/27/2025 15:43:38.248 }</pre> Show as raw text host = 10.10.14.97.8989 source = eventcollector sourcetype = _json

SIEM Investigation

Submitted report:

-Time of Incident: 12/27/2025 15:42:25.164

-User Involved: According to Company Info > Directory:

Name: Michelle Smith

Email: michelle.smith@tryhatme.com

Role: Legal

-Device: win-3459 (Windows host)

-Incident Details: At 12/27/2025 15:42:25.164, a process creation event was logged where svchost.exe (PID 3842) was launched with parent process services.exe (PID 3700). The process executed with command line C:\Windows\system32\svchost.exe -k wsappx -p from C:\Windows\system32\. The activity was flagged due to an uncommon parent-child process relationship.

-Malware Identified: None identified.

-Additional Investigation:

-Additional info:

Parent Process: services.exe is the Windows Service Control Manager responsible for starting, stopping, and managing system services during system operation.

Child Process: svchost.exe is a Windows service host process used to run one or more services from DLL files. In this case, it is associated with the wsappx service group, which handles Microsoft Store and app-related background services.

Why This Is Uncommon: While services.exe does legitimately spawn svchost.exe, alerts may be generated when the service group or timing is less frequently observed. This activity can be normal but should be validated to ensure the service group and execution context align with expected system behavior.

-Recommendations: Escalate to Level 2 (L2) for further investigation and handling.